

## 06 DISINFORMATION

It's getting worse. With all the trolls out there, the sick and twisted humour that is the norm today, it's no wonder that disinformation is the order of the day. Never believe anything you read on social media these days, because almost all of the time you

SOURCE: PIXABAY



Fake news is now quite real thanks to social media

haven't got all the angles of the story to arrive at an informed conclusion of what actually occurred. What's worse is that it's not just individuals doing this, it's now governments as well.

If you followed the recent US presidential election (and you would have to be living under a rock to have not followed it at least a little), you might have heard of a Twitter hashtag called #PizzaGate. It's too complicated to explain this in detail, so we assume you will Google it, but the short version is that a few people (probably Republicans), made up a story about Hillary Clinton being a part of a pedophile ring, about children being kept against their will in a pizza parlour called Comet Ping Pong, and politicians meeting to perform satanic rituals.

Not surprisingly, people on Twitter thought it was really funny and soon the #PizzaGate theory went viral. The problem with people trolling is that they make it sound like they genuinely believe in something, and they often make fake accounts of famous people (or parody accounts) which causes the simpler-minded amongst us to really believe what's being said as the truth. There are parody accounts of Indian celebrities and politicians as well on social media, and they also keep fooling people on a daily basis.

### FAKE OR FACT?

<http://dgit.in/pizaGte>  
<http://dgit.in/UScmpgn>  
<http://dgit.in/CometFake>  
<http://dgit.in/WikiFake>

What's worse is that Russia, during the elections, was suspected of spreading a lot of fake news to try and discredit Hillary Clinton. Whether or not that is true and how successful they were in doing so is totally conjecture, but common sense would tell you that it certainly had some effect – given that quite a few people were willing to believe that Clinton was a blood drinking, child trafficking, pedophile based on just a few tweets by trolls – it's not hard to imagine that those same people believed the disinformation spread by Russia!

### 00110001 00110000

<http://dgit.in/DWave2c>

<http://dgit.in/LightChips>

<http://dgit.in/SiliconNext>

terminology, this is called the internal data bus. The prototype could transfer 300 gigabits/s per square millimeter, this is approximately 10 to 50 times

faster than existing electrical internal data bus speeds. Around 20 to 30 percent of a data centre's energy consumption is spent on electrical communication between the CPU, memory and

network interfaces. The energy saving will be momentous!

Quantum computers are a relatively new and every company have their own way of implementing the technology. D-Wave is one such company with some of the fastest quantum computers on the planet. Their existing hero product is a 1000-qubit quantum computer which has been adopted by the likes of Google, Lockheed Martin, LANL and NASA. While quantum computing itself is a major step in processing power, D-Wave recently

## 07 COMPUTING

We've been using optical fibre to channel data for a few decades now so communication using light isn't new. It's the fastest thing in the universe, but we still haven't managed to shrink the tech to be used at the transistor level



SOURCE: D-WAVE

D-Wave 2X features a 2000-qubit quantum processing power.

in microchips. That's set to change in 2017 thanks to the efforts of a group of researchers from MIT, the University of California, Berkeley and University of Colorado, Boulder.

They've shrunk optical fibre to such a small scale that they could squeeze 850 of them with transmitters and receivers onto a processor. The optical connections were used to move data to and fro between the processor and the memory. In current computing

unveiled the successor to their flagship, the D-Wave 2X. The 2X should have given it away, it's going to be a 2,000-qubit quantum computer but here's the thing – it's 500 to 1,000 times faster!

D-Wave has received some flak from competitors who've claimed that these aren't exactly quantum computers, but we don't care. We'd take any computer that's 500 to 1000 times faster than it's predecessor. This pretty much seems like magic! And that's not all, two to three years down the line, they're promising to multiply performance by a similar factor.